

FINANCE

Overview

The world of finance is an exciting, ever-changing industry filled with a variety of career options. A career in finance can take you around the country or even the globe with many career options. It is a broad program of study designed to prepare you to make reasoned and empirically motivated financial decisions. Upper-level courses include case studies, a student-management investment portfolio, and opportunities to apply foundational skills from earlier courses into specific real-world investments and corporate settings.

As a finance student, you'll learn how companies make financial investments. You'll learn the answers to fortune-building questions and how to take ideas and turn them into reality. The Ivy finance program teaches you how to invest in stocks and bonds and how to advise someone who wants to plan for their future.

Become the expert in making the most of financial markets, successfully raising capital, managing risk, growing assets, and serving the diverse needs of shareholders, partners, and employees. Find your path in banking, investing, security analysis, insurance, government, real estate, or any type of financial management.

When you earn your degree in finance, you'll be equipped with a strong understanding of global market forces and the ability to provide a financial management analytical experience. Finance is also an excellent area if you wish to become more knowledgeable as a consumer, particularly in the fields of investments, insurance, and real estate.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, undergraduate students majoring in Finance will:

1. Be effective communicators.
2. Be effective collaborators
3. Be problem solvers.
4. Understand business concepts.
5. Recognize ethical and legal responsibilities to organizations.

Goals

The instructional objective of the Finance program is to provide a well-rounded professional education in finance. Such an education should provide the students with:

1. A mastery of basic financial concepts and methods of analysis.
2. An understanding of financial operations in a global setting and of the role of financial institutions in the economy.
3. An ability to effectively communicate and work with others as the finance member of a team.

4. An ability to demonstrate leadership capabilities in financial analysis and portfolio management.

Accreditation

The Ivy College of Business is accredited by the Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB International), in both business and accounting. Only two percent of the world's business schools receive accreditation in both business and accounting. AACSB International is an association of educational institutions, businesses, and other organizations devoted to the advancement of higher education in management education. It is also the premier accrediting agency of collegiate business schools and accounting programs worldwide.

Iowa State University is accredited by the Higher Learning Commission (HLC), a commission of the North Central Association of Colleges and Schools.

Explore More

Department Website (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/finance/>)

Contact Information

Primary Contact

- **Name:** Undergraduate Student Services Office
- **Email:** undergrad@iastate.edu
- **Location:** 1200 Gerdin Business Building
- **Phone Number:** (515) 294-8300

College Website

Department Website

Program Administration

- **Owning Academic Unit/College:** Ivy College of Business
- **Coordinating Academic Unit/Department:** Department of Finance

Credential Opportunities

- **Program Duration:** 4 years
- **Credential(s) Offered:** Finance, B.S. (122 credits)
- **Available as an Additional Major:** Yes, Finance, B.S. can either be taken as a primary program of study leading to a single degree credential of Bachelor of Science, or it can be pursued as an additional major in conjunction with another primary program of study and its respective degree credential.
- **Program Limitations:** In addition to the rules regarding degree planning (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), students in this degree program are limited to three business majors/degrees/certificates/minors within the Ivy

College of Business; it should be noted that the Entrepreneurship undergraduate minor does not factor into this count of three programs of study from Ivy. This limit is on business majors/degrees/certificates/minors only and does not apply to multiple majors/degrees/certificates/minors taken outside the Ivy College of Business.

• **Program Designation:** On-Campus Program

Curriculum:

In addition to the basic business degree requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofbusiness/#curriculuminbusinesstext>), finance majors must also complete:

Required Courses (6 credits):

FIN 3100	Corporate Finance	3
FIN 3200	Investments	3

Elective Courses (15 credits):

Select five courses from the following (at least three must be 4000-level or above): *

FIN 3300	Financial Markets and Institutions	3
FIN 3340	Introduction to Financial Technologies and Cryptocurrencies	3
FIN 3610	Personal Risk Management and Insurance	3
FIN 3710	Real Estate Principles	3
FIN 4100	Corporate Financial Planning and Analysis	3
FIN 4150	Business Financing Decisions	3
FIN 4240	Financial Futures and Options	3
FIN 4250	Security Analysis and Portfolio Management	3
FIN 4260	Quantitative Investment Analysis	3
FIN 4310	New Venture Financing	3
FIN 4350	Venture Capital, Private Equity, and Mergers and Acquisitions	3
FIN 4450	Bank Management Decisions	3
FIN 4500	Analytical Methods in Finance	3
FIN 4550	Risk Modeling	3
FIN 4560	Financial Modeling	3
FIN 4620	Corporate Risk Management and Insurance	3
FIN 4720	Real Estate Finance	3
FIN 4740	Real Estate Investment	3
FIN 4800	International Finance	3
FIN 4910	International Study Course in Global Capital Markets	3
FIN 4920	Case Studies in Strategic Financial Decision-Making	1

Total Credits: 21

* You may use one of the following accounting courses to count as a 3000-level Finance course elective:
ACCT 3830 Intermediate Managerial Accounting
ACCT 3860 Intermediate Financial Accounting I
OR...
You may use ACSCI 4010 Loss Models I to count as one of the Finance course electives.

NOTE: Finance majors must take STAT 3226 Intermediate Business Statistics as part of the supporting courses.

NOTE: Students who are completing a double major in Actuarial Science and Finance can take STAT 3441 Introduction to the Theory of Probability and Statistics I in place of STAT 3226 Intermediate Business Statistics.

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Finance, B.S.

Any four year plans shared in the catalog are samples of a potential university experience.

Freshman			
Fall	Credits Spring		Credits
BUSAD 1020 or 1030	1 ECON 1020		3
ECON 1010	3 STAT 2026		3
COMS 1130	3 U.S. Cultures and Communities [#]		3
ENGL 1500	3 ACCT 2840		3
MATH 1500	3 SPCM 3120		3
LIB 1600	1 BUSAD 2030		1
	14		16
Sophomore			
Fall	Credits Spring		Credits
ACCT 2850	3 Core Business Course		3
FIN 3010	3 PHIL 2300		3
MATH 1510	3 STAT 3226		3
ENGL 2500	3 HUM/SOC SCI		3
Natural Science	3 Global/International Perspective [@]		3
	15		15

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ACCT 2150	3 FIN Electives	6
FIN 3100	3 General Elective	3
FIN 3200	3 Core Business Course	3
Core Business Courses	6 HUM/SOC SCI	3
	15	15

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
FIN Electives	6 FIN Elective	3
Core Business Courses	6 MGMT 4780*	3
HUM/SOC SCI	3 Global/International Perspective@	3
ENGL 3020	3 General Electives	5
	18	14

Total Credits: 122

@ Courses in these requirements may also be used as Global Perspective.

U.S. Cultures and Communities courses may be used to satisfy HUM/SOC SCI.

* Must have credit or enrollment in all core courses listed above, except for MGMT 3720, plus senior standing, in order to enroll in MGMT 4780.

Graduation Requirements:

1. Grade of "C" or higher in at least 30 credits of Core and Major courses.
2. 42 credits of 3000+ level courses from a four-year institution.
3. 50% of required Business courses must be earned at ISU.
4. At least 32 credits and the LAST 32 credits must be earned at ISU (exceptions for study abroad and internship may be requested).
5. 122 Credits minimum and a Cumulative GPA of at least 2.00 with no quality point deficiencies.
6. A grade of C or better in ENGL 2500 required, and also in one other required ENGL course.
7. All 3000-level and higher business credits must be earned at a four-year college.
8. Multiple business **majors** must have at least 15 distinct credits in each of the major requirements; when applicable, one course can be shared between business majors; see your advisor regarding multiple business **degree** requirements.

Undergraduate Minor in Finance

The Department of Finance also offers a finance minor for non-finance majors in the Ivy College of Business. The minor requires 15 credits from an approved list of courses, including at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 or above taken at Iowa State University with a grade of C or higher. The minor must include at least 3 credits that are not used to meet any other department, college, or university requirement. Students with declared majors have priority over students with declared minors in courses with space constraints.

Required Course (3 credits):

FIN 3010	Principles of Finance	3
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Elective Courses (12 credits):

Select twelve credit hours from 3000 or 4000 level Finance courses

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For more information on the undergraduate minor in Finance, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/minors-and-certificates/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/minors-and-certificates/>)

Undergraduate Certificate in Real Estate Purpose

The Certificate in Real Estate is a course of study administered by the Department of Finance in the Ivy College of Business. This program provides students from any major or college with a comprehensive understanding of the legal, economic, and financial dimensions of real estate. The certificate enables students with an interest in real estate to showcase their specialized knowledge to potential employers.

Learning Outcomes

After completing the Certificate in Real Estate, students will be able to:

- Understand how properties are owned and operated as for-profit businesses,
- Understand how portfolios of real estate products and securities are structured and utilized as an investment tool,
- Understand the nature of real estate transactions and how they impact the various parties involved in the transaction.

Requirements

The certificate requires at least 21 credits from an approved list of courses. At least 12 credits should be taken at Iowa State University.

Required Courses (12 credits):

FIN 3010	Principles of Finance	3
FIN 3710	Real Estate Principles	3
FIN 4720	Real Estate Finance	3
FIN 4740	Real Estate Investment	3

Elective Courses (9 credits):

Select three electives from the list below:

ARCH 2200	Contemporary Architecture	3
ARCH 3210	History of the American City	3
ECON 2340	Small Business Management	3
ECON 3010	Intermediate Microeconomics	3-4
ECON 3340	Entrepreneurship in Agriculture	3
ECON 3370	Agricultural Marketing	3
ECON 3640	Rural Property Appraisal	3
ECON 3760	Rural, Urban and Regional Economics	3
ECON 4160	Industrial Organization	3
ECON 4310	Managerial Economics	3
FIN 3200	Investments	3
FIN 3610	Personal Risk Management and Insurance	3
FIN 4150	Business Financing Decisions	3
FIN 4310	New Venture Financing	3
FIN 4350	Venture Capital, Private Equity, and Mergers and Acquisitions	3
FIN 4500	Analytical Methods in Finance	3
FIN 4560	Financial Modeling	3
CRP 4160	Urban Design and Practice	6
CRP 4170	Urban Revitalization	3
CRP 4210	Financing Historic Preservation Projects	3
CRP 4420	Site Development	3
CRP 4710	Real Estate Development	3
MKT 3400	Principles of Marketing	3
MKT 3420	Foundation Of Personal Selling	3
MKT 4100	Promotional Strategy	3
MKT 4420	Sales Management	3
MKT 4500	Advanced Professional Selling	3
MKT 4520	Sales Enablement Tools and Technology	3
ENTSP 3130	Feasibility Analysis for New Ventures	3
ENTSP 4540	Entrepreneurial Marketing	3
ENTSP 4610	Entrepreneurship and Accounting Information	3
ENTSP 4800	Applied Entrepreneurship: Executing New Ventures	3
LA 3710	History of Modern Landscapes, 1750 to Present	3
LA 3730	Gardens and Landscapes from Antiquity to 1750	3

MGMT 3200	Corporate Entrepreneurship	3
MGMT 3810	Managing Family Businesses	3
MGMT 4710	Introduction to Human Resource Management	3
MGMT 4730	Evidence-Based Decision Making in Human Resource Management	3
MGMT 4750	Employment Law for Human Resource Management	3

Undergraduate Certificate in Risk Management and Insurance Purpose

The Certificate in Risk Management and Insurance (RMI) is a course of study administered by the Department of Finance in the Ivy College of Business. The certificate will give students, regardless of major or college, a deeper understanding of personal and corporate risk management and of the insurance industry. The certificate will allow students with an interest in risk management and insurance to signal their expertise and focused study to potential employers.

Learning Outcomes

After completing the Certificate in Risk Management and Insurance, students will be able to:

- Understand why insurance markets exist and how they function,
- Understand how insurance companies are structured,
- Understand the various roles that exist in insurance companies and related financial institutions, and
- Be competitive in filling these various roles.

Requirements

The Certificate in Risk Management and Insurance requires the completion of at least 7 courses, totaling 21 credit hours. At least 12 credits must be taken at Iowa State University.

Required Courses (12 credits):

FIN 3010	Principles of Finance	3
or MATH 2400 Mathematics of Investment and Credit		
FIN 3100	Corporate Finance	3
or FIN 3200 Investments		
FIN 3610	Personal Risk Management and Insurance	3
FIN 4620	Corporate Risk Management and Insurance	3

Elective Courses (9 credits):

Select three electives from the list below:

ECON 2340	Small Business Management	3
ECON 2350	Introduction to Agricultural Markets	3

ECON 3010	Intermediate Microeconomics	3-4
ECON 3340	Entrepreneurship in Agriculture	3
ECON 3370	Agricultural Marketing	3
ECON 3710	Introductory Econometrics	4
ECON 4160	Industrial Organization	3
ECON 4310	Managerial Economics	3
ECON 4370	Commodity Marketing and Risk Management: Analysis and Strategy	3
ECON 4660	Agricultural Finance	3
FIN 4240	Financial Futures and Options	3
FIN 4310	New Venture Financing	3
FIN 4450	Bank Management Decisions	3
FIN 4550	Risk Modeling	3
FIN 4560	Financial Modeling	3
ACCT 4010	Financial Management for Healthcare Organizations	3
ACCT 4610	Entrepreneurship and Accounting Information	3
ACSCI 4010	Loss Models I	3
ACSCI 4020	Credibility Theory	3
MATH 2650	Calculus III	4
MATH 3730	Introduction to Scientific Computing	3
MATH 3850	Introduction to Partial Differential Equations	3
MATH 4140	Analysis I	3
MATH 4150	Analysis II	3
MATH 4210	Logic for Mathematics and Computer Science	3
MATH 4410	Life Contingencies I	3
MATH 4420	Life Contingencies II	3
MKT 3420	Foundation Of Personal Selling	3
MKT 4100	Promotional Strategy	3
MKT 4420	Sales Management	3
MKT 4500	Advanced Professional Selling	3
MKT 4520	Sales Enablement Tools and Technology	3
ENTSP 3130	Feasibility Analysis for New Ventures	3
ENTSP 4540	Entrepreneurial Marketing	3
ENTSP 4800	Applied Entrepreneurship: Executing New Ventures	3
MGMT 3200	Corporate Entrepreneurship	3
MGMT 3810	Managing Family Businesses	3
MGMT 4710	Introduction to Human Resource Management	3
MGMT 4730	Evidence-Based Decision Making in Human Resource Management	3
MGMT 4750	Employment Law for Human Resource Management	3
HCM 3020	Economics for Healthcare Managers	3

STAT 3441	Introduction to the Theory of Probability and Statistics I	4
STAT 3442	Introduction to the Theory of Probability and Statistics II	4

Students are responsible for meeting the prerequisites or any enrollment restrictions when registering for the elective courses from the approved list.

Students are limited to three business majors/degrees/certificates/minors within the Ivy College of Business. This limit is on business majors/degrees/certificates/minors only and does not apply to multiple majors/degrees/certificates/minors taken outside the Ivy College of Business.

Students need to fulfill the course prerequisites set by the Ivy College of Business.

Courses taken for a certificate may not be taken on a pass/not-pass basis.

The certificate is intended for students enrolled in a baccalaureate degree program at Iowa State University or that currently hold a baccalaureate degree from an accredited institution. Students holding a baccalaureate degree from an accredited institution must meet admission requirements to be enrolled at Iowa State University.

A certificate is not awarded until baccalaureate requirements are fulfilled.

A cumulative grade point average of at least 2.0 is required in courses taken for a certificate.

For more information on the undergraduate certificates offered by the Ivy College of Business, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/undergraduate-programs/minors-and-certificates/>.

Concurrent Programs

The Department of Finance offers two concurrent degree programs that allow qualified students to be admitted to the following master's programs while completing their undergraduate degree. Students can double count up to 6 credits of coursework between the degrees, allowing them to complete both a bachelor's and a master's degree in an accelerated pathway. The concurrent degree programs offered include:

- B.S. Finance (FIN) and Master of Finance (MFIN)
- B.S. Math (MATH) and Master of Finance (MFIN)

For more information on either of the concurrent programs listed above, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/concurrent-degree-options/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/concurrent-degree-options/>)

Graduate Programs

Master of Finance (MFIN)

The Finance Department offers a Master of Finance (MFIN) degree. The MFIN is a non-thesis, non-creative component curriculum designed to provide students with in-depth coverage of finance topics and a strong quantitative skill set. Students will learn financial analysis and valuation, advanced regression techniques and programming approaches for data analysis, time series analysis and forecasting, optimization techniques, modelling of financial and risk variables, simulation techniques, and tools for effective risk management. The 30-credit program requires 18 core credits. Another 12 credits of electives are required, six of which must be in finance courses.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, Master of Finance (MFIN) students will:

1. Be critical thinkers in finance.
2. Have a broad understanding of financial concepts.
3. Have strong problem solving and decision-making skills.
4. Have a strong background in ethical development.

For more information about the MFIN program, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/master-of-finance/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/master-of-finance/>)

Master of Financial Technology (MFT)

The Master of Financial Technology is a collaborative degree program offered by the departments of Finance and Computer Science. The Master of Financial Technology is a course-only curriculum that focuses on providing a broad set of skills in both financial analysis and computational methods and algorithms. Students will learn how to develop algorithms and data-driven models from computer science curriculum and they will learn how those analytical techniques can be useful to produce value for individual and institutional clients in finance curriculum. Students also have the opportunity to select elective courses from Information Systems which will further their knowledge and inferences from the combination of business and technical foundations. The 30-credit program requires 12 core credits (6 computer science and 6 finance), with 18 elective credits coming from both computer science and business disciplines.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, Master of Financial Technology (MFT) students will:

1. Be able to identify, assess and implement algorithmic and predictive data analysis techniques.
2. Understand the investment landscape and how technological advancements can improve outcomes and efficiency in holding and trading financial assets.

3. Comprehend the value proposition of implementing technological and data-driven solutions for both asset managers and portfolio clients to achieve desired financial outcomes.

For more information about the MFT program, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/master-of-financial-technology/>

Master of Real Estate Development (MRED)

The Finance Department also offers a Master of Real Estate Development (MRED) degree. Jointly created with the College of Design, and with significant input and engagement from industry leaders, the MRED is a 30-credit non-thesis, non-creative component program. The MRED program offers academic training, networking opportunities and collaboration with leading academics and practitioners to solve real world problems. Areas of study include real estate market analysis, finance, investments, leadership and negotiation, fundamentals of the build environment, construction science and urban planning. The curriculum is offered in a convenient format of distance learning and brief campus residencies, making it ideal for the full-time working professional.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, Master of Real Estate Development (MRED) students will:

1. Be knowledgeable in various aspects of real estate.
2. Be critical thinkers in real estate.
3. Be innovators in real estate.
4. Be leaders in real estate.

For more information about the MRED program, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/master-of-real-estate-development/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/master-of-real-estate-development/>)

Double Graduate Degrees

The Finance Department participates in two double degree programs at the graduate level. Students can simultaneously pursue a double degree in Master of Finance (MFIN) and Master of Real Estate Development (MRED), or in Master of Business Administration (MBA) and Master of Real Estate Development (MRED). The double degree plan allows students to share credits between the degrees. See the Director of Graduate Education for more details on sharing credits.

For more information on the double degree in Master of Finance (MFIN) and Master of Real Estate Development (MRED), please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/double-degree-options/mfin-mred/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/double-degree-options/mfin-mred/>)

For more information on the double degree in Master of Business Administration (MBA) and Master of Real Estate Development (MRED), please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/double-degree-options/mba-mred/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/double-degree-options/mba-mred/>)

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

The Department of Finance also participates in the full-time and part-time Master of Business Administration (MBA) program as well as the Ph.D. in Business and Technology program. The MBA is a 48-credit, non-thesis, non-creative component curriculum. Thirty of the 48 credits are core courses and the remaining 18 are graduate electives. Within the MBA program, students may develop an area of specialization in Finance or Real Estate.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, MBA students will:

1. Demonstrate effective communication skills.
2. Effectively lead and work in diverse teams.
3. Critically solve business problems.
4. Integrate ethical and global perspectives in decision making.

For more information about the MBA program with a specialization in Finance or Real Estate, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/ivy-mba/full-time-mba/>.

PhD in Business and Technology

The PhD in Business and Technology with a Finance (FIN) specialization is a 74-credit (minimum) curriculum designed to train students to teach at the university level, to do research that is publishable in top academic journals, and to analyze questions that are important to government agencies and the private sector. Successful students develop close working relationships with the ISU finance faculty, both in the classroom and on co-authored research. We strive for our students to publish their first research study before finishing the program, and to obtain jobs at research-oriented universities in the U.S. and abroad. We emphasize rigorous training and hands-on experience. Five semesters of coursework include a firm grounding in economic theory, thorough training in statistics and econometrics, and an immersion in the most important research studies in corporate finance, investments, and financial institutions.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, PhD students will be able to:

1. Understand and advance knowledge.
2. Create knowledge through original research.
3. Teach effectively in an institution of higher education.

For more information about the PhD program with a specialization in Finance, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/phd-program/finance/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/phd-program/finance/>)

Graduate Certificate

The graduate certificate in finance provides training in investment valuation and the skills necessary to value an entire company through analysis of expected cash flows based on financial statements, growth characteristics, and risk.

The certificate is for graduate students and recent graduates seeking job opportunities as investors or professional money managers, who deal with efficient asset allocation in a portfolio setting, investment performance measurement, and performance evaluation. The certificate is available on campus in Ames.

For more information about the graduate certificate in Finance, please visit: <https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/graduate-certificates/finance/>. (<https://www.ivybusiness.iastate.edu/academics/graduate-programs/graduate-certificates/finance/>)